

Metamorphic rocks

Student: Class:

Rocks — the new generation

You will need:

labelled samples of granite, gneiss, limestone, marble, sandstone, quartzite, shale and slate
hand lens

- Try to sort the rocks into pairs of 'parent' rock and corresponding metamorphic rock.

1. Why is the term 'parent' rock used?
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- Examine each pair of rocks with a hand lens.
- Complete the table below by noting the similarities and differences between the 'parent' and metamorphic rock of each pair.

2. Use the last column of your table to suggest whether the main cause of metamorphism was heat or pressure.

Comparing 'parent' and metamorphic rocks

'Parent' rock	Metamorphic rock	Similarities	Differences	Main cause of metamorphism
shale				
	gneiss			
sandstone				
	marble			